Team teaching material

Table of contents

1 Welcome **1**

2 Guidelines for new Linux Machine setup (centred around Ubuntu) **3**

3 Linux general guidelines **5**
3.1 General Folder layout 5
3.1.1 System-wide location (for core programs) 5
3.1.2 User-specific locations 5
3.1.3 General remarks 6
3.2 Useful Ubuntu commands 7
3.3 General update of Ubuntu 7
3.3.1 Troubleshoots when updating Ubuntu 8
3.4 Network issues 9
3.5 Eduroam connexion 10

4 Git and GitHub **11**
4.1 Github configuration 11

5 Synchronise files across devices **15**
5.1 Serverless 15
5.2 OneDrive and Nextcloud 15
5.2.1 Troubleshoots for OneDrive 18
5.3 Monitor processes in the long-run 22

6 Software to install **23**
6.1 Shell-customisation (including `$PATH`) 26
6.1.1 Zsh (advanced bash configuration) 26

6.1.2 Add executables 26
6.2 AppImageLauncher 27
6.3 PDF management 28
6.3.1 Sioyek as PDF Viewer 28
6.3.2 Sejda for editing PDFs in an interactive way 31
6.3.3 PDFtk 31
6.4 Image Editors (to replace Paint on Windows) 31
6.5 LibreOffice 32
6.6 > Make sure, if avalaible, to download for each font, the regular, bold, italic-bold, and italic versions at the very least. 35
6.7 Docker 36
6.8 Teams 37
6.9 Web browsers 37
6.9.1 Firefox 37
6.9.2 Google Chrome 38
6.10 Slack 39
6.11 Zulip 39
6.12 Cytoscape 39
6.13 Zotero 40
6.14 Quarto, R and RStudio 42
6.15 Python 48
6.15.1 Python dependency core tools 48
6.15.2 Use uv to manage core Python tools, and version management 50
6.15.3 Checking Python versions currently in use 52
6.15.4 Relevant sources for Python tools 53
6.15.5 Python IDE (PyCharm) 53
6.16 Latex 56
6.17 WhatsApp 56
6.18 Cursor 56

7 Working with the remove server 57
7.1 Connexion to the server 57
7.2 Run RStudio remotely 58

7.3 Run `JupyterLab` remotely 62

8 Core numerical tools provided by Aix Marseille Université 65
8.1 AMUZoom 65

9 Miscelleaneous 67
9.1 SSH configuration 67

1 Welcome

This site is built with Quarto as a **book** project. Use the table of contents to open the Linux installation guide.

Download the compiled book as a single PDF: team-teaching-material.pdf.

For other materials in this repository (SNF, Git, package development, etc.), see the project `README.md` in the repository root.

2 Guidelines for new Linux Machine setup (centred around Ubuntu)

3 Linux general guidelines

3.1 General Folder layout

3.1.1 System-wide location (for core programs)

System-wide affects all users, are installed using `sudo`, on the root of the system.

Table 3.1: Main system-wide software locations

Location	Purpose
`/usr/bin`	System executables (APT)
`/etc`	System-wide configuration (example: define repositories for `apt`)
`/opt`	Vendor (external) apps
`/usr/local/bin`	Admin-installed software
`/var`	Logs, caches, databases

- `/opt` for third-party application bundles, **self-contained** while `/usr/local` is for third-party **binaries**. Besides, `/opt` is not in the path by default.

3.1.2 User-specific locations

User does not require root

Table 3.2: Main user-based software locations, to be compared with Table 3.1

Location	Purpose
`~/Applications`	AppImages
`~/.local/bin`	User executables
`~/scripts/tools`	Custom bash executables
`~/.local/share`	User app data, notably `~/.local/share/applications` storing desktop icons
`~/.config`	User configuration

3.1.3 General remarks

- `usr` folder stores *read-only* executables, while `/var` is regularly written upon changes:
  - `/var/lib`: apt and dpkg databases, for instance, respectiely stored under `dpkg`, and `/apt`
  - `/var/cache`: metadata caches for faster execution
- `/usr/local/`, or `$HOME/.local` stores executables that require custom compilation with `make`, or `qmake`, rendered from manual archives:
  - `bin`, `sbin` for executables
  - `share` for icons (under subfolder `icons`) and desktop configuration, documention under `/doc`
  - `lib` for extensions of a given executable (such as packages in R, or modules in Python)
  - This folder hierachy follows `XGD`Base Directory Npecification
- `/tmp` for temporary folders, cleaned after `reboot`
- `/run` for sockets, namely used for controlling all the portocols running in the background for connecting to a server, such as the `ssh-agent`

- `~/.config/systemd`: lists all processes that keep on running in the background, such as Cursor updates, or Onedrive synchronisations.

3.2 Useful Ubuntu commands

- `dpkg --print-architecture`: retrieve architecture, for package installation[1].
- `Ctrl-H` in **Gnome**, aka File Management, to list hidden files

3.3 General update of Ubuntu

1. Create file `update_os.sh` with:

```
#!/bin/bash
rm -rf /var/lib/dpkg/lock-frontend
rm -rf /var/lib/dpkg/lock
apt-get update
apt-get upgrade -y
apt-get dist-upgrade -y
apt-get autoremove -y
apt-get autoclean -y
```

2. Run having `sudo`rights

   i. `chmod +x update_os.sh` to provide executive rights
   ii. `sudo ./update_os.sh` to run the update file with **admin** rights

3. Reboot the system with `reboot`

[1] Returns `amd64` in my case

3.3.1 Troubleshoots when updating Ubuntu

Partial updates breaking key driver components occur more often with Ubuntu compared to Microsoft, since Linux tends to provide lots of separate, modular packages while Windows ships large and standalone bundles -> **Consequence: more issues with updates, especially if the network connection dropped, and the newest versions of the packages were not fully installed.**

Avoid critical update misfunctions with Ubuntu

1. Run daily the following commands:

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt upgrade
```

2. Run monthly:

```
`sudo apt full-upgrade`


# dependences no longer required
sudo apt autoremove
sudo apt autoclean
```

3. 3 commands to solve most driver issues after partial update:

```
# Check for Broken Packages
sudo dpkg --configure -a
# Install missing dependencies
sudo apt -f install

# List all Hardware Driver Errors
dmesg -l err,crit,alert,emerg
```

3.4 Network issues

- Two IP protocols for Wi-FI: `IPv4` versus `IPv6`.

> The two Internet protocols, namely IPv4 vs IPv6
>
> IPv4 is older, but still prevailing in many websites, such as Github, or OneDrive:
>
> – Uses 32-bit addresses (e.g. `192.168.1.10`)
> – Used by **most websites**, CDNs, VPNs, corporate services
> – But the 32-limitation hinders the number of avalaible IP addresses.
>
> IPv6 is newer, but not universally supported:
>
> – Uses 128-bit addresses (e.g. `2a01:cb14:86a7::1`)
> – Supported by modern ISPs and operating systems
> – Some networks provide **IPv6-only**, with no IPv4 fallback. Espaically the case with Microsoft services, governmental or academic websites.

- You can test if this is the issue to connect to some websites with

`curl <webdomain>`, such as `curl https://onedrive.live.com`, returning *Cannot connect*

- Recent modern routers return only IPv6 -> while Windows is able to able to auto-fall back to IPv4, this is not the case of IPv6.
  - *Temporary fix*: by running the following instructions, you solve this issue by automatically configuring a IPv4 upon failure. *Recommended only for short-term debugging.*

```
install dhclient commands
sudo dhclient -4 wlp2s0f0 <Wifi-name> # in my case, wlp2s0f0
```

  - *Permanent fix*[2]:

```
nmcli connection modify "Routeur/Livebox-FC77" ipv4.method auto
nmcli connection modify "Routeur/Livebox-FC77" ipv6.method auto # connect a
# re-start the connection, applying the new configuration parameters
nmcli connection down "Routeur/Livebox-FC77"
nmcli connection up "Routeur/Livebox-FC77"
```

3.5 Eduroam connexion

0. **Ensure to delete beforehand any pre-existing installation: `rm -rf $HOME/.config/cat_installer`.**
1. Go to https://cat.eduroam.org/, the website usually provides with the version fitting your OS distribution.
2. On Linux, download the Python script, choosing AMU university.
3. Run Python script with `python 3 eduroam-linux-AUA.py`
4. As `userid`, provide your academic mail address, and as password, your `ENT password`.

[2]Alternatively, you can rely on the GNOME Interface, `Wifi` section

4 Git and GitHub

4.1 Github configuration

1. Github often requires double authentication, that you can set on https://github.com/settings/security. Recommended to use *passkey* if supported by your device (unfortunately, Linux OS usually do not support it), or use authenticator app, such as Microsoft Authenticator. **Deterred against the use of SMS + mobile phones**.

2. Configure your access to Github:

i. Choose either SSH, or HTTPs.
ii. For HTTPS, configure one token per device, under https://github.com/settings/tokens. Give the token the name of your laptop, its configuration and originals owner. Assign it at least the repo and read scopes. Copy it once -> **it won't be available afterwards!!**.

3. General options to configure:

i. Use either the command line (create also automatically the file `~/.gitconfig`):

```
git config --global user.name "bastienchassagnol"
git config --global user.email "bastien.chassagnol@univ-amu.fr"
```

ii. Or directly, using text editor, file `~/.gitconfig` (more error-prone to indentation errors). Find my default git config file here (for comprehensive description of options, report to Formation Git 2024, a tutorial by Benjamin):

```
[user]
  name = bastienchassagnol
  email = bastien.chassagnol@univ-amu.fr
# modern default git options
[init]
  defaultBranch = main

# simplifying solving git conflicts + troubleshoot solving
[merge]
  conflictstyle = zdiff3
[rerere]
  enabled = true

# tolerate distinct end of lines
[core]
  autocrlf = input

# visualisation
[tag]
  sort = version:refname
[branch]
  sort = -committerdate
[credential]
  helper = store
```

4. Avoid typing your password for every login:

i. For HTTPS + PAT token protocol, use `git config --global credential.helper store` for **permanent** registration of the pass-

word (should we not encrypt the file??), or `git config --global credential.helper 'cache --timeout=3600'` for temporary access[1].

ii. Define SSH key.

[1]Time-out units are reported in seconds, accordingly, this amounts to one hour

5 Synchronise files across devices

5.1 Serverless

- Go for `Syncthing`.

5.2 OneDrive and Nextcloud

> If you already have a monthly pass, and are happy with online edition of the Office toolkit, go for it. Alternatively, `Nextcloud` also allows for interactive use of the Office toolkit, or `Rclone` for syncing files across computers.

1. Install dependencies:

```
sudo apt install build-essential libcurl4-openssl-dev pkg-config git -y
```

2. Add the `OpenSuSE` Build Service repository release key

```
wget -qO - https://download.opensuse.org/repositories/home:/npreining:/debian-ubuntu-onedrive/xUbuntu_

echo "deb [arch=$(dpkg --print-architecture) signed-by=/usr/share/keyrings/obs-onedrive.gpg] https://d

# update cache
sudo apt-get update
```

3. Install `OneDrive`:

```
sudo apt install --no-install-recommends --no-install-suggests onedrive
```

4. Sync OneDrive:

i. Exclude large folders, and directories that are complex and are not recommended for syncing, `nano ~/.config/onedrive/config`. You can see the actual content of my config file under onedrive-custom-config.[1]

ii. Authenticate, and run OneDrive once

```
onedrive --sync --dry-run # optional, list folders that will be synchronsied
onedrive --sync --verbose # first initialisation, usually time-consuming, one-shot
```

4. Permanent synchronization using `systemtcl` facilities. **Highly recommended to remove folders at the local level, rather than on the server**.

```
systemctl --user enable onedrive
systemctl --user start onedrive # in the back end, use onedrive --monitor
```

5. Monitor currently uploaded files:

```
journalctl --user-unit onedrive -f (continous) # equivalent to systemctl --user statu

onedrive --display-config
onedrive --version
```

6. Other useful OneDrive instructions:

- `onedrive --create-share-link <path/to/file>` for read-only shareable links, and `onedrive --create-share-link <path/to/file> --with-editing-perms` to add writing rights.

[1] Note that **Comments must be placed in separated lines, not inline**.

7. (Optional) Visual interaction of OneDrive synchronization:

i. OneDrive system tray program adds a simple icon returning the status of synchronization for OneDrive, that can be controlled with by clicking with the right button of the mouse. **If you decide to use this process, do not run `systemctl --user enable onedrive` `systemctl --user start onedrive`, as it will generate otherwise concurrent processes**. - You'll need to install, and run `qmake` version 5 (by default, on recent Ubuntu configurations, it's the 6th that is used, which does not compile successfully the program).

```bash
# install the 5th version of qmake
sudo apt install qt5-qmake qtbase5-dev

# explicity use the qmake version 5, by calling the entire absolute path
# usually located under folder /usr/lib/qt5/bin
# avoid switching from qmake version 6 to qmake version 5 as default
# using symbolic links, as most recent projects use version 6 of qmake
```

- Run following bash file:

```bash
# create the runnable executive file
git clone https://github.com/DanielBorgesOliveira/onedrive_tray.git
cd onedrive_tray
mkdir build
cd build
/usr/lib/qt5/bin/qmake ../systray.pro # prepare the configuration, such as Makefile
make # build the software

# execute it, such that it runs whenever log in
sudo make install # deploy the software, such as copying files -> here's the sudo incentive
systemctl enable --user onedrive_tray.service
```

```
Source code
   ↓
qmake (.pro → Makefile)
   ↓
make (Makefile → binary)
   ↓
make install (binary → system)
   ↓
systemctl enable (autostart)
```

ii. Customise the logs output reported on the terminal, with the following script that reports in *real-time* a colourised OneDrive activity of the logs: a. Install dependencies: `sudo apt install silversearcher-ag ccze` b. Add `onedrive_log` bash file into folder `~/scripts/tools`. This script is a coloured wrapper of `journalctl` command. c. Add to the `$PATH` using local `.bashrc` the folder `~/scripts/tools`

5.2.1 Troubleshoots for OneDrive

- Call `systemctl --user restart onedrive` after modifying the `.config` file to account for changes within it. For retro-application of configuration changes, use `onedrive --resync --sync --verbose` with parsimony.
- Warning "onedrive application is already running, please check process list" means that several concurrent onedrive are running in the background:
  - List existing processes using onedrive: `ps aux | grep onedrive`
  - Force kill processes that do no not use `systemtcl`: kill -9
- Configure webhooks, if you want *real-time* synchronisation with the server, `server -> local`. **Not recommended generally, as**

complex to configure, and usually irrelevant for daily use cases. Instead, reduce the latency for synchronisation.

- Git and OneDrive do not interfere well for 3 reasons at least, especially when synchronising files on multiple platforms. Linux (and Mac) machines end lines with `LF (Line Feed): \n`, while Windows uses `CRLF (Carriage Return + Lien Feed): \r\n`, Linux tracks file permissions for executables while Windows doesn't (only problematic for shell scripts), finally, `.git` and `.Rproj` folders are complex binary repositories with challenging access and encoding. Three heuristic approaches to solve most issues:

  i. Exclude `.git` folders[2] (or even completely code folders) from the synchronisation. **Note that in this case, the folder will no longer be detected as tracked by `Git` processes.**

  ii. Configure globally the `.gitconfig` configuration file to allow both end of lines indicators, using `git config --global core.autocrlf input` on Linux and Mac machines collaborating with Windows machines[3], and `git config --global core.autocrlf true` on Windows machines[4]. The argument tolerates `CRLF` as it appears, otherwise use by default Linux-like `LF` endings. **This approach solves most of my synchronisation conflicts**.

  iii. **Best practice**: per project, create a `.gitattributes` defining explicitly the encoding of EOL, removing the dependency to the machine OS[5]. By default, you should opt in ofr the `LF` EOL:

```
# 3 columns: file extension, file type (text, or binary), eol definition for text documents
* text=auto eol=lf # modify EOL both globally, as the default behaviour, if `core.autocrlf` is n
# AND custom configuration, per file extension
```

[2] Adding argument `skip_dir = ".git"` to OneDrive config file
[3] Accept as EOL CRLF, but always commit as LF
[4] on Windows machines, checked out as `CRLF`, but committed as `LF`
[5] Detailled information is avalaible here

```
*.sh   text eol=lf
*.py   text eol=lf
*.js   text eol=lf
*.ts   text eol=lf
*.java text eol=lf
```

Apply changes with the following commands:

```
git add --renormalize .
git status # display files being impacted by the change of EOL encoding
git commit -m "Normalize line endings"
```

iv. **Discard local changes**, induced by degenerate EOL diffs, with:

```
git status # Review of existing changes
git clean -fd # Optional, remove untracked files and directories as well
git reset --hard HEAD
```

to discard all local modifications to **tracked, but unstaged files**, practically bringing the working tree back to the last commit.

v. Configure the editor:

w. VS Code → `Settings > Text Editor > Files > Eol`, go for the `\n`, or `auto` option. To apply it on pre-existing files, use *Change End Of Line Sequence command*.

ii. RStudio: `Tools → Global Options → Code → Saving -> Line ending Conversion → (Posix) LF`.

> ⚠ Graphical Interaces for OneDrive
>
> Avoid using graphical interfaces, such as OneDriveGUI, they poorly concur with local installation of `onedrive` on my personal experiment. Instead, rely on the terminal, as it usually provides the user with

better customisation, and control on OneDrive configuration.

⚠ Compatibility with Applications Using Atomic Save Operations

Many modern editors, such as `LibreOffice` and `Rstudio` use **atomic save strategies** to preserve data integrity when writing files.

```
file.qmd
↓ edit
file.qmd.tmp # If OneDrive synchronises in the meantime, it believes that the file had been discarde
↓ rename
file.qmd


# Architecture causing this problem
RStudio
   │
   │ save
   ▼
Local file (.qmd)
   │
   │ filesystem event
   ▼
onedrive client
   │
   │ sync
   ▼
OneDrive cloud
   │
   │ sync back
   ▼
local overwrite
```

This process is likely to interfere with the regular synchronisation protocol of the `onedrive` client relying on **inotify**, triggering editor warnings, or even temporary removal of files contents.
Three complementary solutions to address these issues, and reduce conflicts between editor saves and sync detection.

1. Do not put active projects inside `OneDrive`, setting apart large documents storage synchronised with OneDrive, from source code version by Git.
2. Pause sync while coding. **But you need to think about restarting the synchronisation afterwards**.
3. Twist the configuration file, helping with editors using atomic saves:

```
force_session_upload = "true" # avoid overwriting by older cloud versions, when RSt
delay_inotify_processing = "true" # wait for RStudio to finalise the saving of tmp
```

5.3 Monitor processes in the long-run

- `systemctl list-unit-files --type=service --state=running --user` to list all processes running in the background, even after rebooting, restrained to the user-level.
  - Alternatively, processes at the system-level are stored under `/lib/systemd/system/`
- `systemctl status <service>` retrieves current status

6 Software to install

**General recommendation*: avoid using `ChatGPT`, as the instructions for installing software are often deprecated and/or not following Ubuntu best guidelines.

Install software on Ubuntu, some guidelines

Three recommended methods, depending on Ubuntu's support:

1. If supported by Ubuntu, go for `apt install` for system software[1]:

- *automatic updates* and security patches -> **it's the only method allowing it in a systematic way**.
- easiest method for installation
- signed and verified packages
- recommended for *core system*, long-term software
- If **not directly available on Ubuntu's native package manager, or using in the back-end `snap` commands**, switch to pre-built tarball installation[2], or add the repository (only if **trusted**) to `apt allowed keys` folder. Example for `Docker`, Section 6.7, or custom Zotero installation file.
- **.deb files** are intended for Linux distributions derived from Debian (such as Ubuntu, Linux Mint, etc.), while **.rpm files**

are mainly used by distributions derived from Red Hat–based systems (such as Fedora, CentOS, and RHEL) + `openSUSE` distribution:

  - No auto-updates
  - Potential dependency issues
  - **Always install with `sudo apt install`, rather than `sudo dpkg -i`, to better solve dependencies, fix broken installs, and ensures system consistency.**

---

2. `AppImages` are standalone executable files, bundling the application and most of its dependencies:

- Recommended for *desktop applications* to be installed only on the user account -> does not require `sudo` rights in most cases
- Portable
- Works across many distributions
- `AppImageLauncher` can help in organising all AppImages within the same folder + integrate them into the system menus:
  - Relevant if using multiple AppImages
  - Using menu integrations and icons
  - Avoid `Snap`

---

3. Pre-built tarball (`.tar(gz|xz)`) archives:

- Stronger customisation
- Works without distribution packages
- May fail when built / requires manual handling/no automatic updates

- **Only recommended for developers, or if nothing else exists**.

- And now, the not recommended installations:
  - `snap` stores pre-compiled versions of tools, but are less recommended compared to standard installation with `sudo apt install`
  - `FlatPak+Flathub`

Conclusion: APT first (if not directly available, add the repository to the trusted keys of `apt`) -> AppImage second -> `.deb` if AppImage is not available -> source build in the worst case.

Table 6.1: Pros and Cons of Package installations for `Ubuntu` users

Feature	AppImage	tar/build	apt install	.deb
Root required	no	sometimes	yes	yes
Dependency handling	Bundled	Manual	Automatic	Partial
Auto-updates	no	no	yes	no
System integration	Low	Medium	High	High
Portability	Excellent	Low	None	Low
Stability	App-dependent	Variable	Excellent	Good
Recommended for beginners	yes	no	yes	

- Other choices of importance:
  - `portable`, or not. Portable installation is not managed by `apt`, easier to remove (does not leave leftovers/footprints, as only installed locally, in the home directory), but does easily enable desktop integration (with icons, for instance), nor allows for automatic updates
  - Non-portable applications are usually better for daily/intensive use, but not *sandboxed*, and harder to remove (configuration files installed in root directories)

6.1 Shell-customisation (including `$PATH`)

6.1.1 Zsh (advanced bash configuration)

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install zsh

# define this shell shebang by default
chsh -s $(which zsh) # modify /etc/passwd repository
```

6.1.2 Add executables

- System-wide:

[2] `apt-get` works similarly, but is now deprecated

[2] Fetch the latest stable archive, extract it, and add executables to your `PATH`, see example under Section 6.13

  - `/usr`, and manual installs under `/usr/local` are in the `$PATH` by default
  - For third-party GUI, *self-contained* apps stored under `/opt`, add a symlink: `sudo ln -s /opt/<appName> /usr/local/bin/<appName>`, requires **`sudo` rights**.

- User-level:

  - Customise `.bashrc` (or `.zshrc`) configuration files to modify the `$PATH` -> **Only affects the user, and interactive shell**. Examples:

```
export PATH="$PATH:$HOME/scripts/tools"
alias ll='ls -lah'
```

  - AppImages may be integrated using AppImageLauncher, or `.desktop` configuration.

- Deal with multiple versions of the same program (for instance, `Java`): use `update-alternatives --list <AppName>` to list executables.

6.2 AppImageLauncher

```
# download the .deb archive, with the proper architecture configuration
# https://github.com/TheAssassin/AppImageLauncher/releases/tag/v3.0.0-beta-3

sudo apt install appimagelauncher_3.0.0-beta-2-gha287.96cb937_amd64.deb

# update dependencies
sudo apt update
sudo apt install -f
```

- For deleting apps installed with AppImage Launcher, you'll need to delete both *Applications* folder, and `~/.local/share/applications/` that stores executables.

6.3 PDF management

6.3.1 Sioyek as PDF Viewer

`Sioyek` is an open-source PDF viewer focusing on technical papers with mathematical formulas. Major uses cases are coloured *highlights* of text sections with `h` shortcut, smart jump to figures by clicking on them, and bookmark text sections with shortcut `b`.

1. Choose between portable (for isolated environment), or standard distribution under Sioyek releases
2. Unzip the archive, within it, make it executable with `chmod +x`.
3. Run it

> ℹ A step-bystep tutorial for the installation from source an Ubuntu application, from downloading the archive to adding it to the Path, and to the Start programm
>
> To turn any exec into a **desktop application** on Ubuntu-GNOME, follow this steps:
>
> 1. Relocate everything under **`/opt/sioyek`**[3]. **Note that the structure of a package may not follow exactly this of `sioyek`!!

```
# create required folders

sudo mkdir -p /opt/sioyek
sudo mkdir -p /etc/sioyek
sudo mkdir -p /usr/share/sioyek

# relocate, if not already done, the sioyek builds

## core executables
sudo cp ~/sioyek/build/sioyek /opt/sioyek/
sudo chmod +x /opt/sioyek/sioyek

## confgiuration files
sudo cp ~/sioyek/build/prefs.config /etc/sioyek/
sudo cp ~/sioyek/build/keys.config  /etc/sioyek/
sudo cp -r ~/sioyek/build/shaders /usr/share/sioyek/
sudo cp ~/sioyek/build/tutorial.pdf /usr/share/sioyek/
```

3. Add a distinctive icon, and customise the native Ubuntu launcher 'Gnome'

```
sudo mkdir -p /usr/share/icons/hicolor/256x256/apps # folder to store the siokey.pn

sudo tee /usr/share/applications/sioyek.desktop > /dev/null <<'EOF'
[Desktop Entry]
Version=1.0
Type=Application
Name=Sioyek
GenericName=PDF Viewer
Comment=Fast keyboard-driven PDF viewer
Exec=/opt/sioyek/sioyek %path to the sioyek exe
Icon=sioyek
Terminal=false
Categories=Office;Viewer;
MimeType=application/pdf;
StartupNotify=true
EOF

# Refresh desktop database
sudo update-desktop-database
```

4. (Optional) Make Sioyek the default **PDF viewer**, using either:
   a. GUI method:
      1. Right-click any PDF
      2. **Properties → Open With**
      3. Select **Sioyek**
      4. Click **Set as default**
   b. or the command line:

```
xdg-mime default sioyek.desktop application/pdf

# to check default
xdg-mime query default application/pdf
```

5. add to the Path, creating a symbolic link

```
sudo ln -s /opt/sioyek/sioyek /usr/local/bin/sioyek
```

6.3.2 Sejda for editing PDFs in an interactive way

- Web version
- Sedja *add-on* for Chrome

6.3.3 PDFtk

- To edit PDFs, if you prefer the command line.

6.4 Image Editors (to replace Paint on Windows)

Sorted from closest experience to Paint, to most generalist:

1. `Drawing`

   i. Add Drawing to the `apt` repository of allowed PPAs: `sudo add-apt-repository ppa:cartes/drawing`
   ii. Install running `sudo apt install drawing`

2. `Libre Office Draw`
3. `Gimp` (closer equivalent to `Photoshop`):

```
sudo apt install gimp
sudo apt install gimp-plugin-registry # add extensions
```

[3]default repo for third-party apps, preventing conflicts with distributed, native packages

6.5 LibreOffice

1. Install main software (such as Libre Office Write, or Calc) with `sudo apt install libreoffice libreoffice-gtk3`

2. Relevant extensions, that you can add using `Tools -> Extensions`

i. Rotate Images in free text documents with *Rotate* extension
ii. Install dictionaries + extension Grammalecte and LanguageTool[4]. *needs to check if LanguageTool is truly relevant, is AI-based, but also resource-consuming.*

```
# French dictionary
sudo apt update
sudo apt install libreoffice-l10n-fr # add French hyphenation
```

iii. Install Latex extension

3. Fonts customisation:

i. Install core Windows fonts:

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install ttf-mscorefonts-installer # Install Microsoft core fonts
fc-cache -f -v # rebuild font cache, such that the fonts now appear In Libre Office
```

ii. Extra fonts installation[5]. Most popular fonts can be found under Every-Font GH repository:

[4] You may configure the Java version used by default under `Tools -> Options -> Advanced`

[5] Alternatively, you also have the native Fonts manager tool under GNOME launch start

```
mkdir -p ~/.local/share/fonts # ensure personal fonts folder is created
wget -P ~/.local/share/fonts "https://raw.githubusercontent.com/serendipious/every-font/master/Century
fc-cache -f -v # update font cache
```

Core typographic options

The main stylistic variants of fonts you can play with are:

1. Weight (Light, Regular, Bold, …)
2. Angle or shape of the letters (regular versus italic)
3. Width
4. Serif vs Sans-Serif. This property is structural to a font, for instance, `Times New Roman`is Serif, and `Century Gothic` is `Sans-serif`. **For data visualizations, or presentations, `Sans-serif` typefaces are favoured, while it's the reverse for printed documents.**
5. Advanced font options and customisations, such as controlling for *ligatures* connecting two letters, can be accessed in `LibreOffice → Format → Character → Features` (see Figure 6.1):

6.6 > Make sure, if avalaible, to download for each font, the regular, bold, italic-bold, and italic versions at the very least.

Figure 6.1: Main typographic options

6.7 Docker

1. Download dependencies, configuration files and add repository to apt for automatic updates:

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install ca-certificates curl # dependencies for downloading packages, and ve

# Part I: create, download and make Docker apt key readable for verifying its integri
sudo install -m 0755 -d /etc/apt/keyrings
sudo curl -fsSL https://download.docker.com/linux/ubuntu/gpg -o /etc/apt/keyrings/doc
sudo chmod a+r /etc/apt/keyrings/docker.asc

# Part II: define where, and which version of Docker, should be donwloaded + how to v
sudo tee /etc/apt/sources.list.d/docker.sources <<EOF
Types: deb
URIs: https://download.docker.com/linux/ubuntu
Suites: $(. /etc/os-release && echo "${UBUNTU_CODENAME:-$VERSION_CODENAME}")
Components: stable
Signed-By: /etc/apt/keyrings/docker.asc # folder previously defined
EOF

# Part III: update with newer configuration
sudo apt update
```

2. Install Docker toolkit with `sudo apt install docker-ce docker-ce-cli containerd.io docker-buildx-plugin docker-compose-plugin`

3. Check installation with `sudo docker run hello-world`. If not running by default upon login, enable automated start with `sudo systemctl start docker`. More details here.

6.8 Teams

- **Use the web version, as Microsoft no longer supports .deb versions for Linux.**

6.9 Web browsers

6.9.1 Firefox

> **Avoid running directly `sudo apt install firefox` -> it installs by default `snapd`, and will use not stable, beta `Snap` version of Firefox.**

1. Import, and add Mozilla APT signing key:

```
# Download APT key
wget -q https://packages.mozilla.org/apt/repo-signing-key.gpg -O- | sudo tee /etc/apt/keyrings/package

# Add it to the Apt registry
cat <<EOF | sudo tee /etc/apt/sources.list.d/mozilla.sources
Types: deb
URIs: https://packages.mozilla.org/apt
Suites: mozilla
Components: main
Signed-By: /etc/apt/keyrings/packages.mozilla.org.asc
EOF

# Provide higher priority to Mozilla Firefox

echo '
Package: *
Pin: origin packages.mozilla.org
```

```
Pin-Priority: 1000
' | sudo tee /etc/apt/preferences.d/mozilla
```

2. Install Firefox using Mozilla provider:

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install firefox

which firefox # should not report `snapd` folder
apt policy firefox
```

6.9.2 Google Chrome

1. Install Google Chrome, by downloading the .deb archive, then run it:

```
sudo apt install google-chrome-stable_current_amd64.deb`
```

2. Download, and add Google Chrome APT signing key, for automatic updates:

```
# Download APT key
wget -q -O - https://dl.google.com/linux/linux_signing_key.pub | sudo gpg --dearmor -

# Add it to the Apt registry
echo "deb [arch=amd64 signed-by=/usr/share/keyrings/google-linux-signing-key.gpg] htt

# Update to the most recent version
sudo apt update
```

6.10 Slack

1. Download Slack application
2. Run it with `sudo apt install slack-desktop-4.47.69-amd64.deb`
3. Update with:

```
sudo apt-get update
sudo apt-get upgrade slack-desktop
```

6.11 Zulip

1. Run following instructions:

```
sudo apt install curl # if not already installed
sudo curl -fL -o /etc/apt/trusted.gpg.d/zulip-desktop.asc \
    https://download.zulip.com/desktop/apt/zulip-desktop.asc
echo "deb https://download.zulip.com/desktop/apt stable main" | \
    sudo tee /etc/apt/sources.list.d/zulip-desktop.list
sudo apt update
sudo apt install zulip
```

2. Log-in (recommended with your Github profile) on each of the channels you want to connect, to keep notified about newest posts.

6.12 Cytoscape

> Major default: only supported by Java version 17 (and not by more recent, and stable Java versions!!)

1. Install Java version 17 with `sudo apt install openjdk-17-jdk`[6]
2. Follow this tutorial

i. Retrieve the latest version
ii. Make it executable with `chmod u+x <filename.sh>`
iii. Execute with `sh`, or simply `./` (avoid using `sudo` if irrelevant for other users of the computer)
iv. Launch with `Cytoscape &`.

6.13 Zotero

1. `sudo apt install libreoffice-java-common -y` adds Java dependencies to seamlessly integrate Zotero with Libre Office *plug-in* (for instance, automated retrieval of bibliographic references).

2. Retrieve the latest stable version on https://www.zotero.org/download/[7].

3. Run following instructions + Synchronise by installing Zotero Connector on your website:

```
#!/bin/bash

# part I: extract archive
sudo tar -xjf zotero.tar.bz2 -C /opt
sudo mv /opt/Zotero_linux-x86_64 /opt/zotero

# Part II: add the executable
sudo ln -s /opt/zotero/zotero /usr/local/bin/zotero
```

[6] On Ubuntu, a more modern version of Java, the 21, was installed
[7] Alternatively, download with `curl`

4. (Optional: add a custom Desktop, and launcher icon for an executable) Create file `~/.local/share/applications/zotero.desktop`, with the following content. Make the launcher executable with `chmod +x ~/.local/share/applications/zotero.desktop`

```
[Desktop Entry]
Name=Zotero
Exec=/usr/local/bin/zotero
Icon=/opt/zotero/icons/icon128.png
StartupWMClass=Zotero
Type=Application
Terminal=false
Categories=Office;
MimeType=text/plain;x-scheme-handler/zotero;application/x-research-info-systems;text/x-research-info-s
X-GNOME-SingleWindow=true
```

5. Inspired from Zotero hacks tutorial, enable unlimited synced storage for articles on multiple machines.

i. Add required plug-ins, `Better BibTeX` (mandatory for custom expert as a plain .bib file) + `Zotmoov`, which replaces previous extension `Zotfile` for classifying articles per author's name.
ii. Edit Zotero preferences[8]: - Uncheck the option to create automatic web page snapshots (increases cluttering with lots of small files added) - Uncheck full-text sync - Set apart in `Edit->Settings->Advanced` the

   - Base directory (should be the folder synced by your File sharing software), with
   - Custom Data directory location. This local folder should be located in a different position, and will be managed by Zotero itself

[8]What matters the most here is uniformity across platforms

```
![Zotero Database Configuration](zotero-advanced-configuration.png)
```

iii. Edit `Better BixTex` *plug-in*: - Personally, use `[auth:lower][year][journal:lower:abbr]` - Should be the same across machines.

6.14 Quarto, R and RStudio

1. To get the latest R Versions, add the signing key, along with the repository:

```
sudo mkdir -p /etc/apt/keyrings
sudo wget -O /etc/apt/keyrings/cran.gpg https://cloud.r-project.org/bin/linux/ubuntu/
echo "deb [signed-by=/etc/apt/keyrings/cran.gpg] https://cloud.r-project.org/bin/linu
```

2. Install R:

i. Install basic dependencies

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install r-base r-base-dev -y
R --version
```

ii. Install recommended Ubuntu system libraries for scientific computing and/or connection:

```
# Compilation tool
sudo apt install cmake

Network, imaging, and plotting libraries
sudo apt install \
build-essential \
libpng-dev \
libjpeg-dev \
```

```
libtiff-dev \
libcairo2-dev \
libcurl4-openssl-dev \
libssl-dev \
libxml2-dev \
zlib1g-dev

# scientificic libraries
sudo apt install \
  build-essential \
  gfortran \
  libblas-dev \
  liblapack-dev \
  libgsl-dev
```

3. Install RStudio (Desktop IDE)

i. Go to: https://www.rstudio.com/products/rstudio/download/#download/ Choose the **Ubuntu/Debian `.deb` package** for your architecture (amd64).
ii. Step 2 — Install the `.deb` package:

```
sudo apt install ./rstudio-2025.09.0-422-amd64.deb
```

4. Install Air, as the recommended, fast and modern formatter for R code. Then, customise your RStudio settings, explicitly reporting the path location of Air formatter, see Tip 1.

```
uv tool install air-formatter
```

Tip 1: Sync RStudio options across platforms

1. **Locate the repository on your system that stores RStudio settings**. There's no direct means for exporting RStudio parameters that have been modified by the user. Instead, the key directory storing core RStudio settings is located under `~/.config/rstudio/` for Linux, and `%AppData%\RStudio` for Windows[9]. The key files in this repository are:

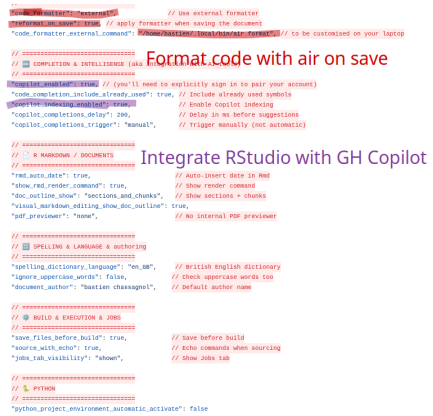
File	Purpose
`rstudio-prefs.json`	Global preferences modified by the user
`keybindings/`	Custom keyboard shortcuts
`themes/`	Custom themes (if any)
`snippets/`	Code snippets
`dictionaries/`	Custom dictionaries beyond English, and French

2. **Identify what it's worth relevant for syncing**: indeed, while you could export all the RStudio settings for a complete backup, most of them are optional, or barely modified by regular users. Instead, I would identify, and retrieve only the settings explicitly changed by the user. > Would use local, or online diff editors, such as diffcheckers to quickly identify what changed between personal configurations. > Specifically, all external tools that complement the functionalities of RStudio, such as pdf previewer, or external formatters such as Air, are hard-coded as absolute paths, and are accordingly highly specific to a personal laptop.

3. **Homogenise settings across machines**: once you've finalised the customisation of the RStudio settings to your specific OS configuration, simply overwrite pre-existing *user-specific* settings file `rstudio-prefs.json`. **Restart RStudio** to check if changes were properly integrated into the graphical interface[10].

   To simplify the syncing across machines (especially for teams with shared computing environment), use either: 1. Git-based sync, storing your dotfiles. This is the recommended approach. You can find my settings files under `rstudio-prefs.json`. See also Figure 6.2 for a more comprehensive explantion of core changes brought to a default, native RStudio configuration. 2. use symbolic links, or cloud sync (but you have fewer options to adjust for changes)

(a) In yellow, core reproducibility options. Notably, avoid loading your R session, and objects on start, for reduced use of memory



(b) Styling and linting of R code with `Air Posit`, and integration with AI helpers.

Figure 6.2: Core options to change the default behaviour of RStudio, enabling enhanced compatibility across projects, R Versions, and OS platforms.

4. Install Quarto, Go to https://quarto.org/docs/get-started/

```
sudo apt install ./quarto-1.3.496-linux-amd64.deb
quarto check
```

[10] `%AppData%` is a shortened alias for this expanded path on Windows: `C:\Users\<YourUser>\AppData\Roaming\RStudio`

[10] If some of the setting changes were not applied, you can usually access them from the Menu options with `Tools > Global Options...`

6.15 Python

From **PEP 668**. guidelines, applied to modern Debian/Ubuntu distributions with native Python installed above the `3.11/3.12` version, `pip` is prevented from modifying the **system Python** as it could interfere with te core installation program `apt`.

This section is certainly the most controversial of this whole Ubuntu tutorial, as guidelines for a modern programmatic use of Python evolve rapidly, without reaching a full agreement

6.15.1 Python dependency core tools

Modern Python development guidelines

1. The latest versions of Ubuntu, including `Noble`, strongly deter from installing system-wide versions of recent Python packages. In other words, avoid running `sudo apt install python3.14-full`, and updating Deadsnakes PPA.
2. `uv` fully replaces the functionalities and features brought by a variety of slower, standalone Python tools (`pip`, `poetry`, `virtualenv`, `pipx`, …), providing a faster, versatile and unified framework, see Figure **??**. **The features provided by `poetry` for package development may still not be fully covered by `uv`, and `pip`remains the legacy solution in older HPC systems:**

```
/usr/bin ## Pre-installed Ubuntu system
 └── system Python (used by OS)

uv
 ├── managed Python versions
 ├── CLI tools (black, ruff, jupyterlab)
 └── project environments

~/.local/share/uv/python/
   ├── python3.14
```

3. `conda`, and even `mamba` have been outdated by `pixi` for multi-language projects. **`uv` is definitely the go-to solution for Python-centric projects, but does not support yet cross-language project managements**. Of note, `uv` natively enforces the use of virtual environments when running Python scripts, see Table 6.3.
4. The field renews fast -> stay alert, and up-to-date to the latest trends in this tech world.

Table 6.3: Comparison of Python environment and dependency management tools

Feature	uv	Poetry	Pixi
Speed			
Dependency management			
Virtual environments			
Python version install			
Package publishing	Acceptable	Best	Limited
Non-Python dependencies			
CI performance			
Maturity	Medium	High	Medium

6.15.2 Use uv to manage core Python tools, and version management

I now describe the core steps to use the latest stable Python version (currently, 3.14), without breaking core Linux dependencies using pre-installed Python version.

1. Install uv with the following command: `curl -LsSf https://astral.sh/uv/install.sh | sh`.
2. Install latest Python version with uv: `uv python install 3.14`.
3. Two configuration levels for setting up the Python version

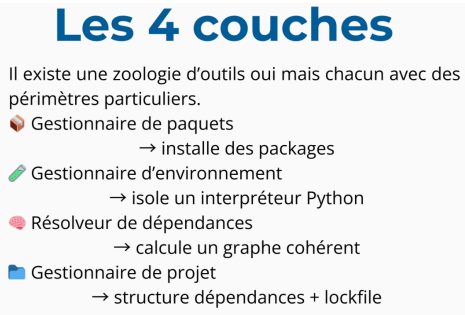
   i. At the project level, run `uv python pin 3.14`.
   ii. At the user level: `bash cd ~ echo "3.14" > ~/.python-version`

4. Use uv instead of pipx to install core Python tools for package dependency, web IDEs, modern Python formatting and styling, ….
   As pipx, all these tools are automatically added to the user's PATH:

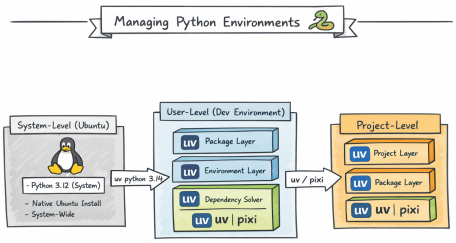
```
uv tool install ruff # ~ equivalent to pipx install ruff
uv tool install black
uv tool install jupyterlab # `JupyterLab` outdates previous `JupterNotebook` as a web
uv tool install ipython
uv tool install pre-commit
uv tool install poetry
uv tool install cookiecutter `Cookiecutter` generates Python templates for modern pac
```

Python version maangement: core checks

- Check integrity of system Python:



(a) Each tool used to have its perimeter, hence the diversity of Python execs

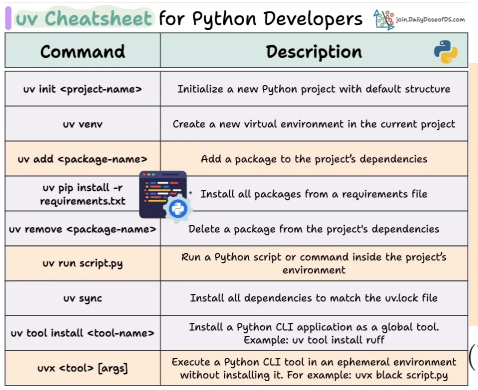


(b) The three levels of Python environments, from system-wide (not to be modified) to the project level

	Paquets	Env	Resolver	Projet
pip	✓	✗	✓	✗
venv	✗	✓	✗	✗
conda	✓	✓	✓	✗
mamba	✓	✓	✓ (rapide)	✗
poetry	✓	✓	✓	✓
uv	✓	✓	✓ (rapide)	✓
pixi	✓	✓	✓	✓

(c) Side-by-side compariosn of the core use cases of each Python tool -> `uv` supersedes them all.

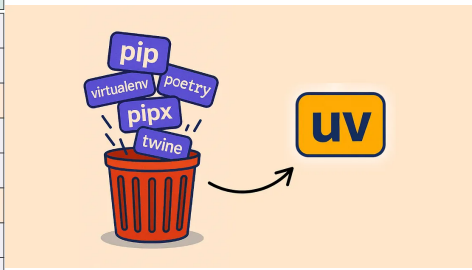
Figure 6.3: Comparison of Python managers.



uv Cheatsheet for Python Developers

Command	Description
uv init <project-name>	Initialize a new Python project with default structure
uv venv	Create a new virtual environment in the current project
uv add <package-name>	Add a package to the project's dependencies
uv pip install -r requirements.txt	Install all packages from a requirements file
uv remove <package-name>	Delete a package from the project's dependencies
uv run script.py	Run a Python script or command inside the project's environment
uv sync	Install all dependencies to match the uv.lock file
uv tool install <tool-name>	Install a Python CLI application as a global tool. Example: uv tool install ruff
uvx <tool> [args]	Execute a Python CLI tool in an ephemeral environment without installing it. For example: uvx black script.py

(a) Main commands to replace old-fahsioned Python tools by `uv`.



(b) Caricature illustrating the recent domination of `uv`

```
ls /usr/bin/python* # -> # only one version expected, Python 3.12 with modern Linux
/usr/bin/python
/usr/bin/python3
/usr/bin/python3.12
```

- Check version used by `uv`:

```
ls -la ~/.local/share/uv/python* # path returned should be located within the HOME
```

6.15.3 Checking Python versions currently in use

- From the terminal (system-wide), run `ls -d /usr/lib/python3.*`, or `which -a python`. This command should only return a unique version of Python, the one used by Ubuntu.

- From a Python shell (including Jupyter Lab):

```python
import sys
print(sys.version)
print(sys.executable)
print(sys.path)
```

6.15.4 Relevant sources for Python tools

- From Pip to Lightning: How `uv` Opened My Eyes to Better Python Workflows
- LinkedIn portfolio on Python dependencies management tools

6.15.5 Python IDE (PyCharm)

PyCharm versus Spyder

Historically, the two main IDEs for developing in Python are `Sypder` and `PyCharm`.
Spyder is recommended for individual and temporary projects, such as running short-term data analysis scripts, and was commonly used in the research community.
However, `PyCharm`, while having a steeper learning curve, is much more scalable to larger, and collaborative projects. If you plan to use Git, or connect to databases, or develop tools addressed to the wide research community, or work in remote sessions, or within containerised environments, it's definitely the tool to pick up. Besides, it now supports native integration with AI-coding agents.

> In conclusion, `PyCharm` is far more common in modern professional programming for Python-centric projects, an dhas mostly superseded Spyder. Again, if you need multi-language to run your analyses, switch to VS Code for

> smoother and integrated development process.

1. Ask for a complete PyCharm pro installation, providing your own academic mail.
2. Extract, and install PyCharm:

```
tar -xzf pycharm-*.tar.gz
sudo mv pycharm-* /opt/pycharm # recommended folder in Ubuntu for external applicatio
bash /opt/pycharm/bin/pycharm.sh # installation script
sudo ln -s /opt/pycharm/bin/pycharm.sh /usr/local/bin/pycharm # add PyCharm to the PA
```

3. (Optional) Use `Tools → Create Desktop Entry` to add PyCharm to the GNOM Application Menu.

   Recommended mondern setup of Python projects within `PyCharm`, when using `uv` as dependency manager (see Section 6.15.2), and following modern programming framework:

1. Create a virtual environment, and project with `uv venv`.
2. Under `File → Settings → Project → Python Interpreter` (also available as shortcut `Ctrl-Alt-S`), ensure that `Add Interpreter → Existing` explicitly points to the `python` version stored with the `venv` `project: <project path>/.venv/bin/python` -> that way, you ensure the project is fully isolated, and does not conflict with pre-existing dependencies.
3. The project structure should look like as (seel also Figure 6.5):

```
project/
 ├── .venv/ # stores Python dependencies
 ├── pyproject.toml # stores Python module versions
 └── src/ # stores Python scripts for running the application
```

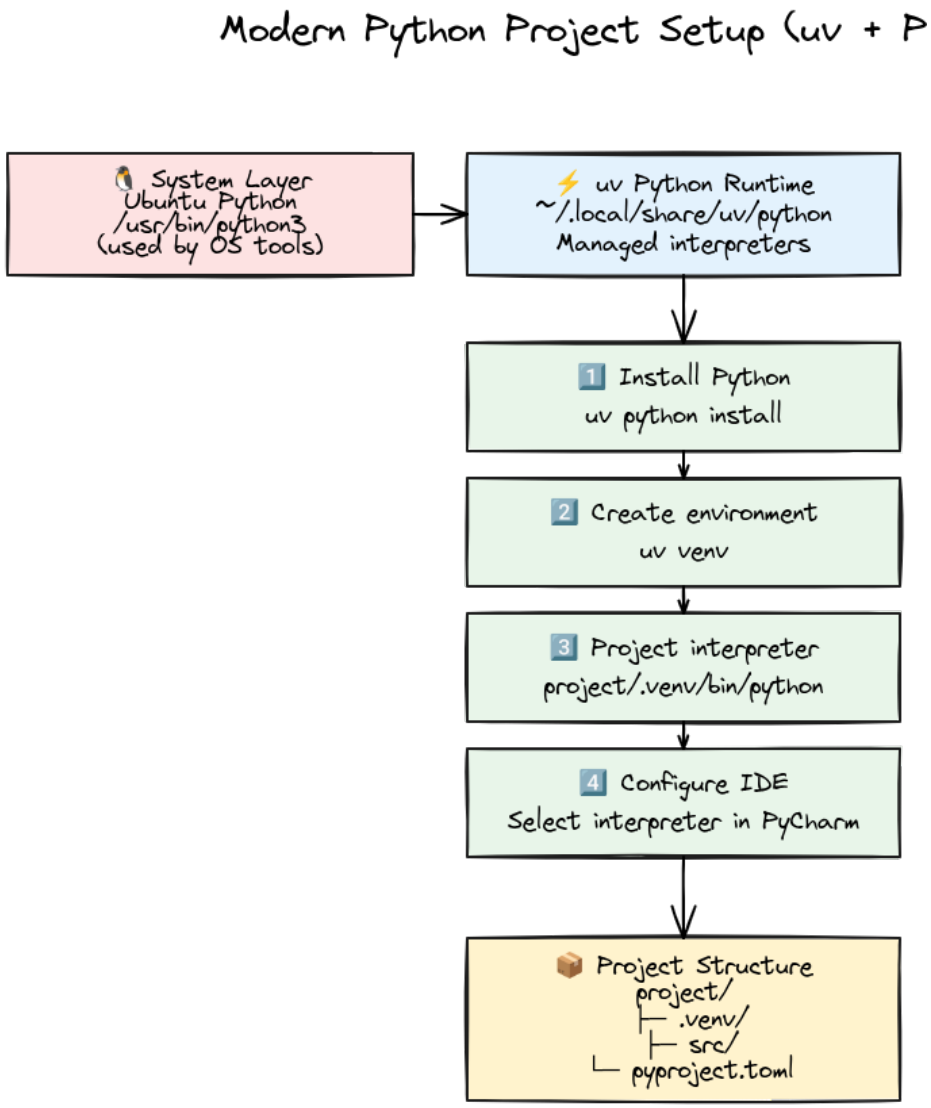


Figure 6.5: `uv + PyCharm` setup, representing the different layers in which Python Interpreter live, and the modern and recommended workflow for creating Python projects fully solated, and reproducible

6.16 Latex

```
sudo apt install texlive-full -y
# other commonly used packages
sudo apt install texlive-latex-extra texlive-fonts-recommended texlive-science biber
```

6.17 WhatsApp

- No supported local Linux installation
- Instead, recommended to use the Web version of WhatsApp, then pair it with your mobile device.

6.18 Cursor

1. Download DEB extension.
2. Run it:

```
sudo apt install ./cursor_2.0.77_amd64.deb
```

7 Working with the remove server

Retrive its identity on the server

```
id ${USER}
uid=1001(bastien) gid=1001(bastien) groups=1001(bastien),4(adm),24(cdrom),27(sudo),30(dip),46(plugde
```

- list of groups on the server, identify is defined by the combination of an username, `UID` (user ID), and `GID` (group ID) on both servers.

```
id ${USER}
uid=1007(bastienc) gid=1007(bastienc) groupes=1007(bastienc),1043(dtoo_project)
```

More information avalaible under Server Management tutorial.

7.1 Connexion to the server

- SSH protocol (see details at Table 7.1)

  ```
  ssh -p 22218 -XC bastienc@139.124.156.52
  ```

  with:

- `139.124.156.52` the port (`139.124.156.52` is for the new server, recommended over `139.124.156.51`, as benefiting from larger data storage, and larger computational resources, such as graphical cards)
- `bastienc` the user ID
- `22218` the port[1]
- Both `-Y` and `-X` options are required for allowing the use of remote GUIs, such as `RStudio`. `--Y`is more secure than `-X`, but on our server, **the `-Y` option induces strong latency, and windows freezing*.
- Always use the `-C` (for compression), allowing faster data transfer between local, and remote server.

Table 7.1: Comparison side-by-side of the main options for customised `ssh`connexion

Option	Purpose	Effect on X11
`-X`	X11 forwarding (untrusted)	Runs GUI apps remotely
`-Y`	X11 forwarding (trusted)	Runs all GUI apps remotely
`-C`	Compression	Reduces network usage and can speed up GUI over slow connections

7.2 Run RStudio remotely

In Table 7.2, we compare side-by-side approaches for using `RStudio` with files stored remotely on the server:

[1]Commont port is 22, so it's likely one that is going to be hacked. Hence our change to the canonical port

Table 7.2: Remote connexion to distant server, a comprehensive review

Method	Where RStudio runs	Speed	Setup difficulty	Pros	Cons
SSH + X11 (`ssh -YC`)	Server	Slow	Very easy	No setup required	Laggy UI, slow plots
SSHFS + local RStudio	Local machine	Fast UI	Easy	Edit remote files easily	Local computation
RStudio Server (web)	Server	Fast	Medium	Best remote workflow	Requires installation
Terminal + Rscript	Server	Fast	Very easy	Simple, reliable	No IDE
Git + Github	Custom choice	Fast	Medium	File versioning	Code sharing mostly

Tip 2: Configure, and use `SSHFS` in practice

`SSHFS` protocol uses a combination of the following operators: SSH, SFTP (for file opeartations) and FUSE (Filesystem in Userspace).

1. Install `sshfs` with

```
sudo apt install sshfs
```

1. Create the *mounting point*:

```
sshfs -p 22218 bastienc@139.124.156.52:<"remote-URL-absolute-path"> <"local-url-path"> -o reco
```

will create the following virtual filesystem connection[2]:

```
Remote server                      Your computer
-----------------                  ---------------------
/home/bastienc/project  <--SSH--> ~/remote_project
# 3-layered structure mounting
Application (RStudio, editor)
        |
        ▼
FUSE filesystem
        |
        ▼
SSHFS driver
        |
        ▼
SSH connection
        |
        ▼
Remote filesystem (server)
```

2. Open the project you want to edit with `RStudio` (if `RStudio` is already opened, reload your session to have the latest version fo the files). Every change is reported back with the *remote server*, without syncing delay. Same if the file is modified remotely. **Refresh regularly to witness any remote change**.

3. Once done, unmount the project:

```
fusermount -u <"local-url-path"> # OR
umount "<"local-url-path">
```

If the folder was not empty, it returns back to the stage previous mounting.

4. List all currently moundted file systems with:

```
findmnt -t  #OR
mount | grep sshfs
```

You may use the R package [`ssh`](install.packages("ssh") if you don't enjoy using the CLI command. **beware of much limited features**.

Optionally, on startup, you can mount remote files, editing the `/etc/fstab` file, but this requires `root` rights, and SSH automated key authentication (no prompting of the password is allowed). It can also be done on-demand (when the folder is actually accessed)

```
# startup mounting
sshfs#bastienc@139.124.156.52:/home/bastienc/project /mnt/cluster_project fuse.sshfs _netdev,port=22

# on-demand mounting
sshfs#bastienc@139.124.156.52:/home/bastienc/project /mnt/cluster_project fuse.sshfs _netdev,port=22

# test the automated mounting
sudo mount -a
```

We report under Warning 1 the key guidelines to enable a smooth edition workflow:

[2] the `-o`option guarantees that the connection is re-established if interrupted

Caution 1: DO and DON'ts of using `sshfs`

- It's not a synchronisation, nor a duplication of the files. Once unmounted, the local system returns to its initial state.
- There is no automatic conflict management (last wins), hence, it's recommended to combine it with `Gitin` collaborative projects.
- Do not forget to unmount the files once done to close the SSH remote connexion
- It's fast for editing small text files, such as code snippets. But consumes a lost of resources for large datasets.
- Favour absolute paths, as `sshfs` does not expand well HOME directory ~ on a remote machine.

7.3 Run `JupyterLab` remotely

I replaced the **older Conda-centric workflow** provided by Philippe with this more **modern, minimal workflow**, using safer connection protocols, removing the requirement for Conda, manual kernel installation, and permanent connexion with `autossh`:

1. Create the environment on the server:

i. With `Pixi`: "'bash # environement creation, with some custom Python modules pixi init pixi add python jupyterlab ipykernel numpy pandas matplotlib

```
# environment activation
pixi shell
```

ii. With **uv**:

```bash
uv venv
source .venv/bin/activate

uv pip install jupyterlab ipykernel
python -m ipykernel install --user --name project_env # optional, specifiying which Python kernel to u
```

2. Run JupterLab remotely:

```bash
ssh -p 22218 bastienc@139.124.156.52
jupyter lab --no-browser --port=8888
```

3. Create a permanent SSH tunnel connection:

```bash
ssh -L 8888:localhost:8888 -p 22218 bastienc@139.124.156.52 # creates connection local computer port 8

# go to local web browser, and copy paste the token previously identified
http://localhost:8888

# stabilise the connection, by running Jupyter in the background (detach terminal)
tmux | jupyter lab --no-browser --port=8888 ## create another terminal windows
Ctrl + b d # detach it in the backe-end

# optional: add an alias in `~/.bashrc` to connect directly to remote jupyter lab
alias jlab-server='ssh -L 8888:localhost:8888 -p 22218 bastienc@139.124.156.52'
```

Remaining question: replace this workflow with **JupyterLab Desktop**??

8 Core numerical tools provided by Aix Marseille Université

List of numerical tools used in Amu

8.1 AMUZoom

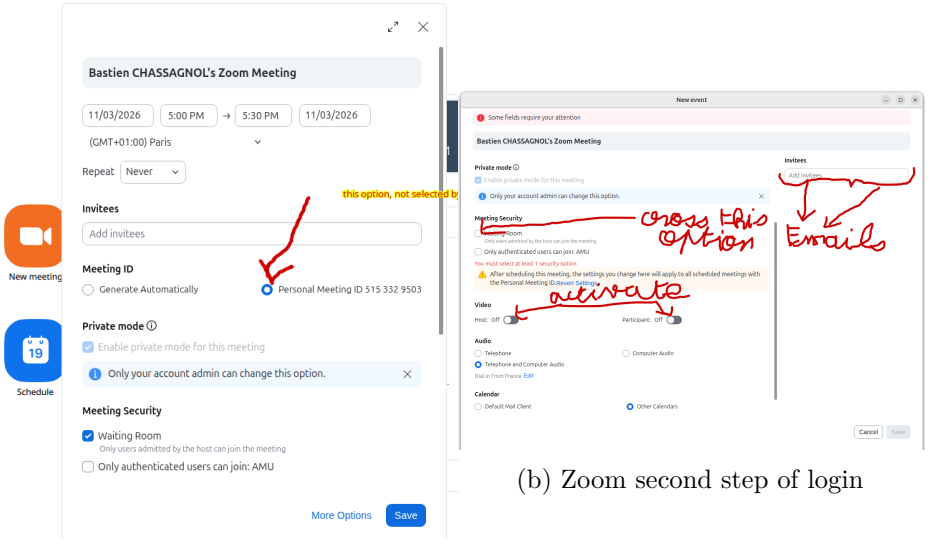
1. Retrieve latest version, choosing proper Linux distributions and OS architecture under Zoom downloads. Also avalaible online. Strongly recommended to install Zoom locally.
2. Run `sudo apt install ./zoom_amd64.deb`
3. **Log-in using your university email address, using `SSO`.** The account is provided with unlimited meetings available by default, use following domain: `univ-amu-fr`. [1]

   2 elements, listed below, to keep in in mind, when creating a Zoom meeting to enable any external user, with the password, to ling-in, and share its screen, see Figure 8.1:

To go further, check the following online resources:

- Guidelines for Zoom Meeting creation, and management
- Video tutorial
- Guidelines for students

[1] Alternatively, use the web version available here



(a) Zoom first login

(b) Zoom second step of login

Figure 8.1: Be careful about selecting the second, non-default option, if you want to allow external suers without any Amu mail address to connect on your Zoom session.

9 Miscelleaneous

9.1 SSH configuration

> Objective is dual: avoid typing your password each time you're connecting to a remote cluster, and keep a safe storage of all registered remote hosts:

1. Set up SSH remote access (with key-based auth)

```
# remote server must have openssh-server installed
sudo apt install openssh-server
```

2. Generate a pair of public-private SSH key on your local machine[1]

```
ssh-keygen -t ed25519 -C "your_email@example.com"
```

This creates:

```
- `~/.ssh/id_ed25519` (private key)
- `~/.ssh/id_ed25519.pub` (public key)
```

3. Copy your key to the server with `ssh-copy-id username@server_ip`. You'll no longer need typing your password once typed once.

[1] Using a passphrase is not compuslory, but safer

4. (Optional) Keep under `~/.ssh/config` file the key features describing each remote cluster. For instance, my configuration for the IFB is the following, and to connect to it, I only need typing now `ssh ifb-core`. A second advantage of using this format for storing hosts is that it can be readily used by `VS Code SSH Remote` connection extensions.

```
# 🔹 alias for the host connection, either "ifb-core" or "ifb"
Host ifb-core ifb

  # 🌐 The real hostname (or IP) of the remote server
  HostName core.cluster.france-bioinformatique.fr

  # 👤 Username used on the remote machine
  User bchassagnol

  # 🔑 Path to your private SSH key
  IdentityFile ~/.ssh/id_ed25519

  # 🔒 Force SSH to use ONLY the specified key above, avoiding complex managing of key
  IdentitiesOnly yes

  # 🔐 Order of authentication methods: SSH key, then keyboard-interactive, then fallb
  PreferredAuthentications publickey,keyboard-interactive,password

  # 🔄 Automatically add this key to ssh-agent when used
  AddKeysToAgent yes
```

My host configuration, enabling by default graphical interfaces to run on the remote server, is avalaible under config-ssh

---

Ssh configuration recommendations

On older Ubuntu configurations, the `shh-agent`, and `shh-add` processes are not activated by default on startup. Check this by running this command:

```
systemctl --user enable ssh-agent
```

Use `GNOME Keyring` to store SSH keys securely

Report to Table 9.1, and Figure 9.1 for further details

Table 9.1: SSH recommended practices

Practice	Why
Prefer Ed25519 keys	Small, fast, modern default.
Use a passphrase on the key	Protects the key if the disk is copied or stolen.
`~/.ssh/config` per host	Aliases, and login recommendations
Never commit private keys	Keep `id_*` out of git and cloud-synced folders.
`ssh-copy-id` once per host	Standard way to populate `authorized_keys`.

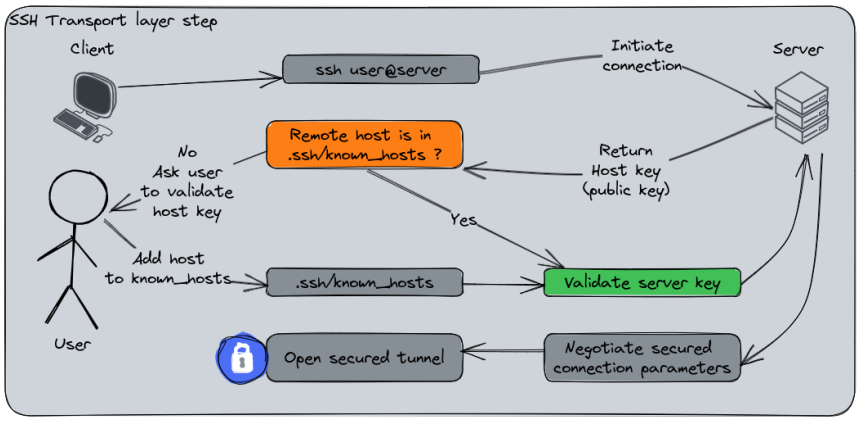


Figure 9.1: Overview of an initial SSH connection